

Unit 1: The first six

پہلے چھ حرف

1 In this unit

Joiners vs the non-joiner alif; alif as long ā; the three short-vowel marks zabar, zer, pesh.

How long: About 3 hours for a child, 1.5 for an adult. Do 10 minutes a day, short and happy.

2 What to say and show, letter by letter

	Say	How the pen moves	Often mixed up with
ا	alif الف 'a' in father when long	one stroke, top to bottom	lām
ب	be بے 'b' in bat	start top-right, shallow bowl leftwards, hook up; dot last	nūn
ک	kāf کاف 'k' in kite	base stroke first, right to left, then the sloping cap on top	none yet
ل	lām لام 'l' in log	tall stroke down, curve into the bowl	alif
م	mīm میم 'm' in mat	small loop, tail down-left	none yet
ن	nūn نون 'n' in net	deep round bowl; dot last	be

3 How to use the sheets

1. **Trace and write:** one page per letter. Start at the dot, follow the arrow; body first, dots last.
2. **Look-alikes:** circle the same letter, then sort by dots.
3. **Join the letters:** standing letters into a joined word.
4. **Read and match:** word to meaning.
5. **Reading practice:** words, sentences, story.
6. **Dictation:** the grown-up says it, the child writes it.
7. **Unit check:** 10 questions. The answer key is the last page of the unit-check PDF; in the unit pack the keys are on the last pages.

4 How to check

- **Letters:** cover the sound, point to the letter, the child says it. 3 of 4 right is a pass.
- **Writing:** look at the start dot and the direction, not at how pretty it is. Right to left, body first, dots last.
- **Unit check:** 8 of 10 means go on. Under 8: redo the look-alike and trace sheets, try again tomorrow.
- **Praise effort:** "you started on the right", "good dots". One sheet a day beats five at once.

5 A 10-minute sitting

2 min warm-up: point to last time's letters, the child says them. **5 min** the sheet of the day: say it, trace it, write it. **3 min** read it back together and end on something done well.

Trace and write: alif

Name _____ Date _____

alif الف

Sound: 'a' in father when long

the body only: no dots

How the pen moves: one stroke, top to bottom.

● Put your pencil on the green dot and follow the arrow. Say the sound as you write.

Alone



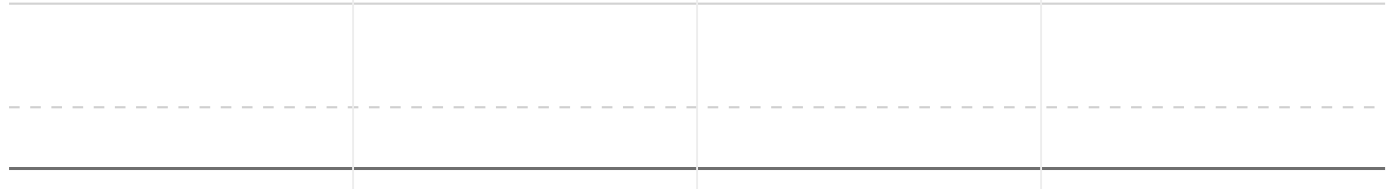
Again, alone



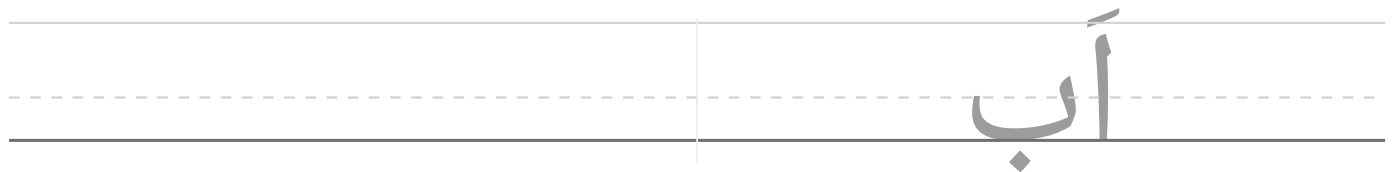
End of a word (the letter before it joins to it, it does not join forward)



From memory: write it alone



In a word: ab (now)



Trace and write: be

بے

Name _____ Date _____

be بے

Sound: 'b' in bat

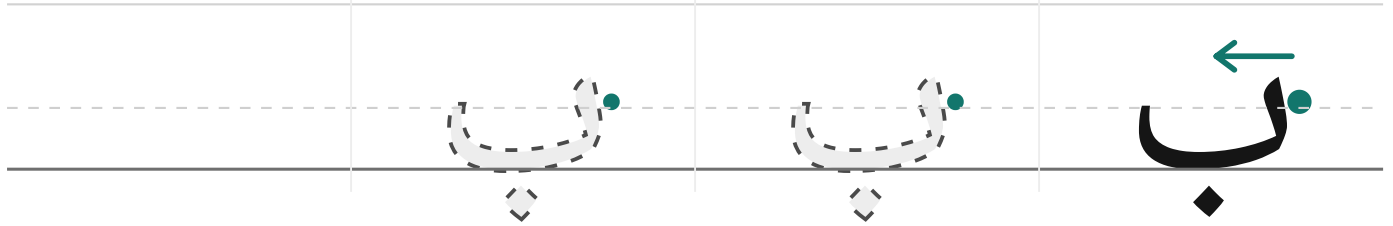
step 1: the body

step 2: 1 dot

How the pen moves: start top-right, shallow bowl leftwards, hook up; dot last.

● Put your pencil on the green dot and follow the arrow. Say the sound as you write.

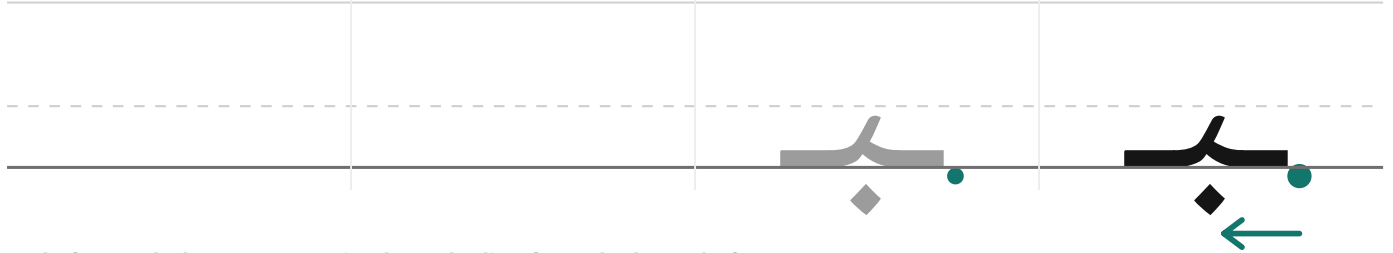
Alone



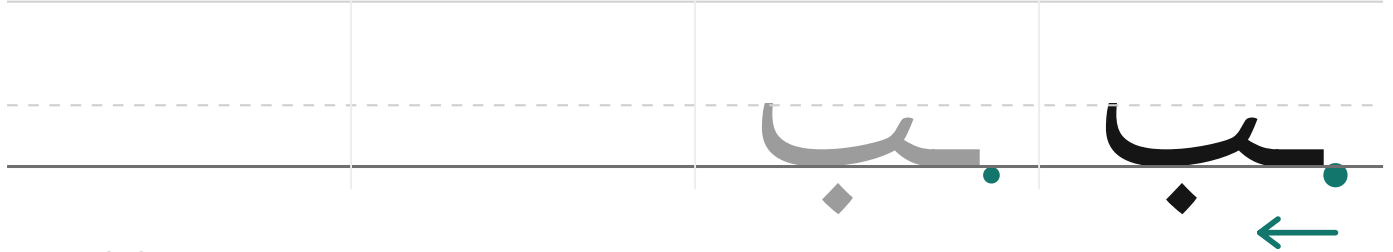
Start of a word (joins to the next letter)



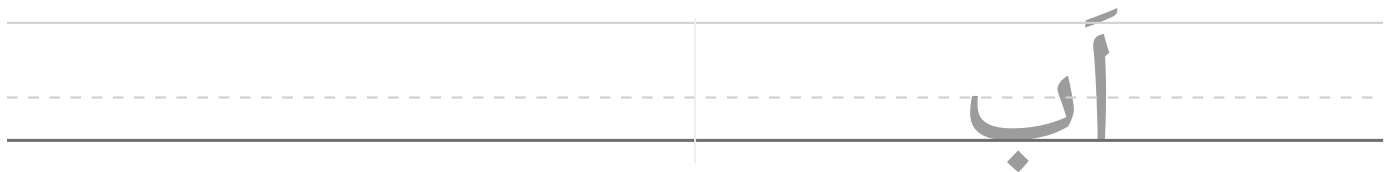
Middle of a word (the pen comes in along the line from the letter before)



End of a word (the pen comes in along the line from the letter before)



In a word: ab (now)



Trace and write: kāf

Name _____ Date _____

kāf کاف

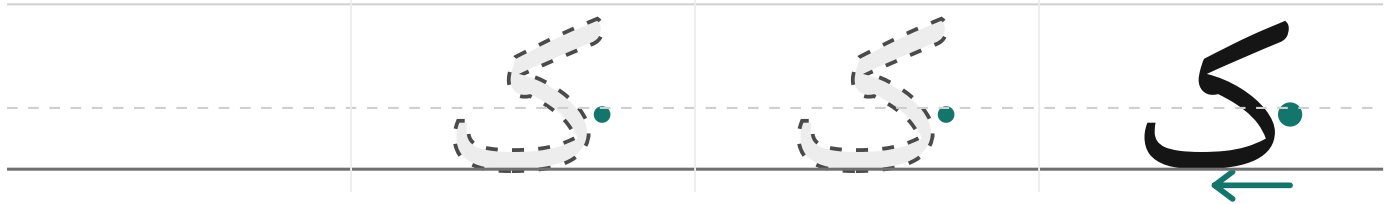
Sound: 'k' in kite

the body only: no dots

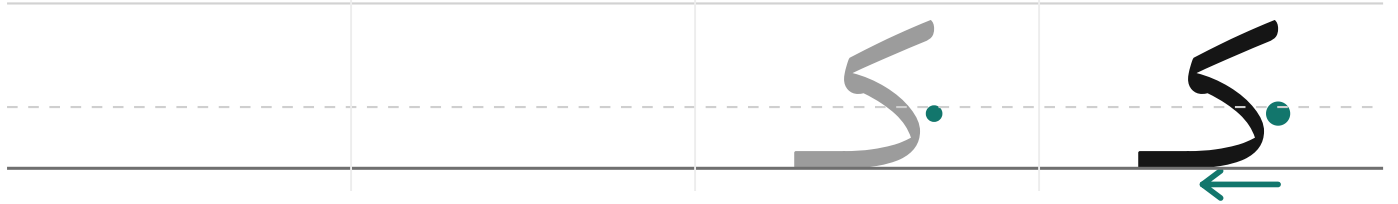
How the pen moves: base stroke first, right to left, then the sloping cap on top.

● Put your pencil on the green dot and follow the arrow. Say the sound as you write.

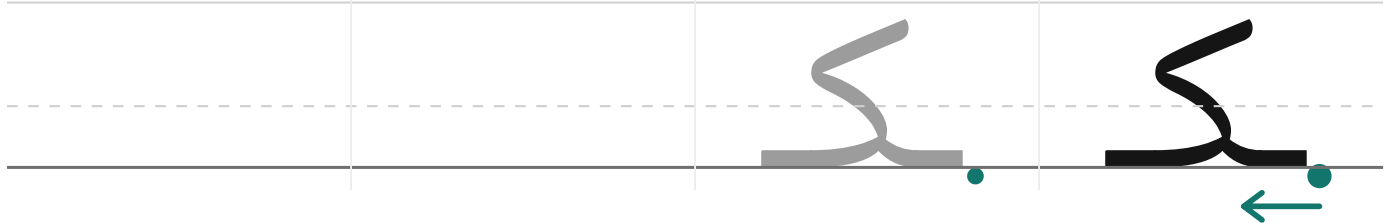
Alone



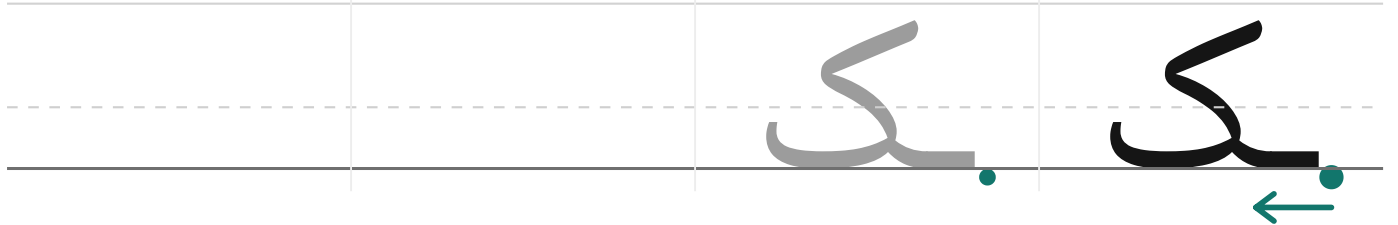
Start of a word (joins to the next letter)



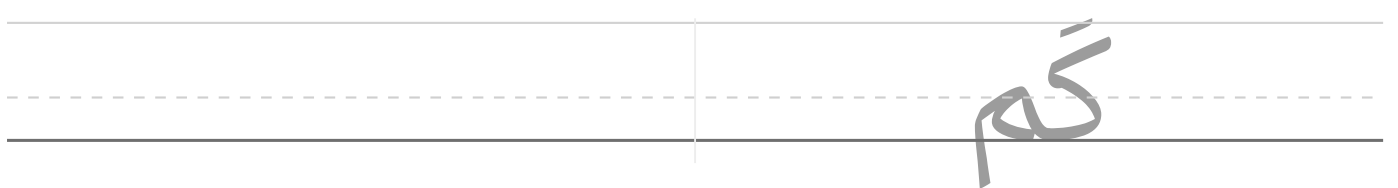
Middle of a word (the pen comes in along the line from the letter before)



End of a word (the pen comes in along the line from the letter before)



In a word: kam (few, less)



Trace and write: lām

لام

Name _____ Date _____

lām لام

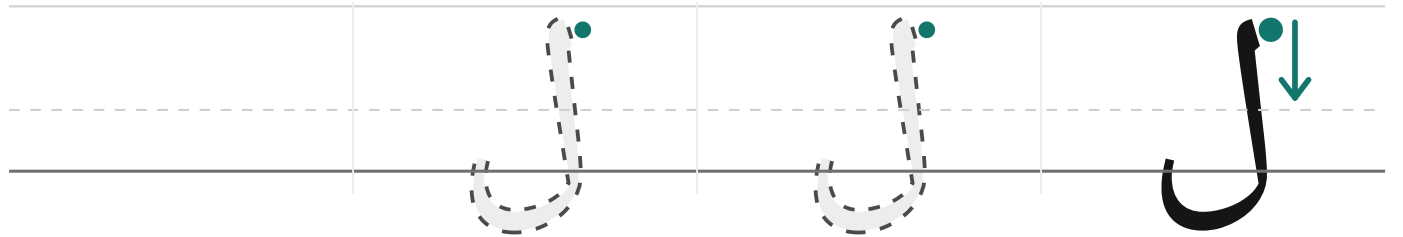
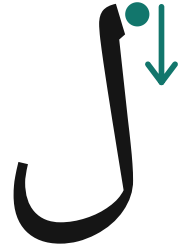
Sound: 'l' in log

the body only: no dots

How the pen moves: tall stroke down, curve into the bowl.

● Put your pencil on the green dot and follow the arrow. Say the sound as you write.

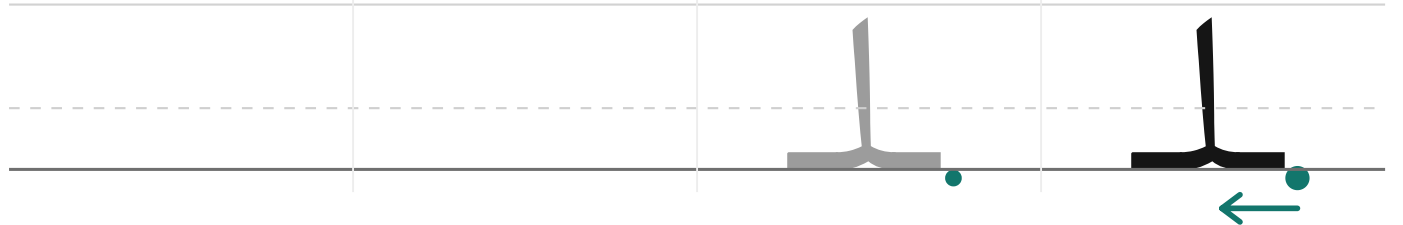
Alone



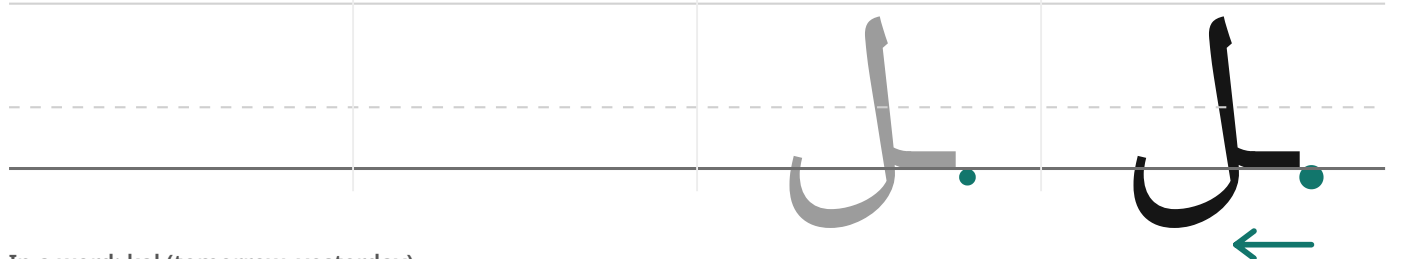
Start of a word (joins to the next letter)



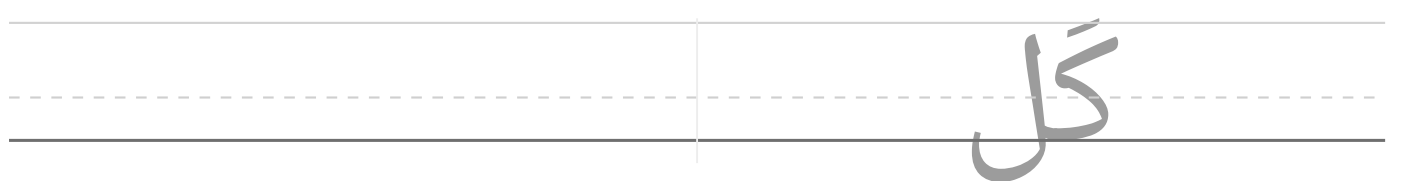
Middle of a word (the pen comes in along the line from the letter before)



End of a word (the pen comes in along the line from the letter before)



In a word: kal (tomorrow, yesterday)



Trace and write: mīm

میم

Name _____ Date _____

mīm میم

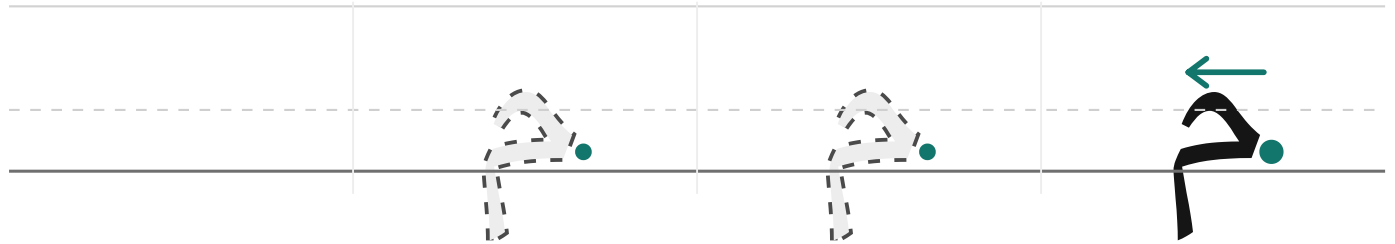
Sound: 'm' in mat

the body only: no dots

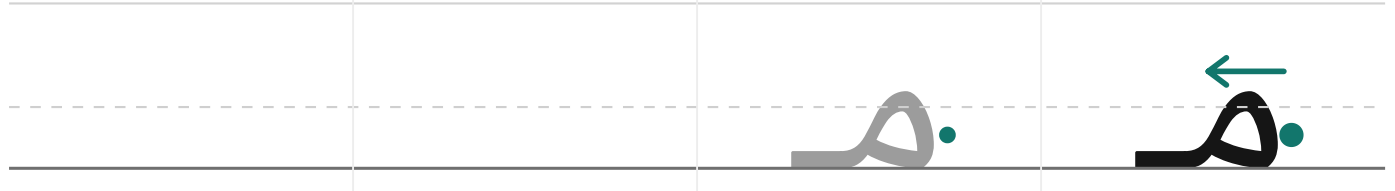
How the pen moves: small loop, tail down-left.

● Put your pencil on the green dot and follow the arrow. Say the sound as you write.

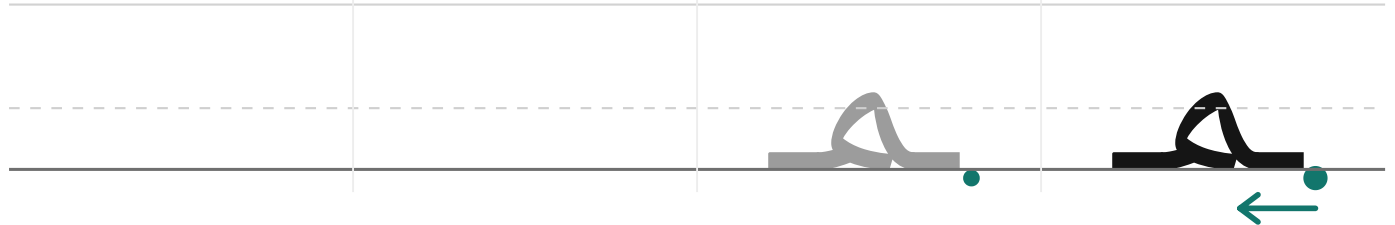
Alone



Start of a word (joins to the next letter)



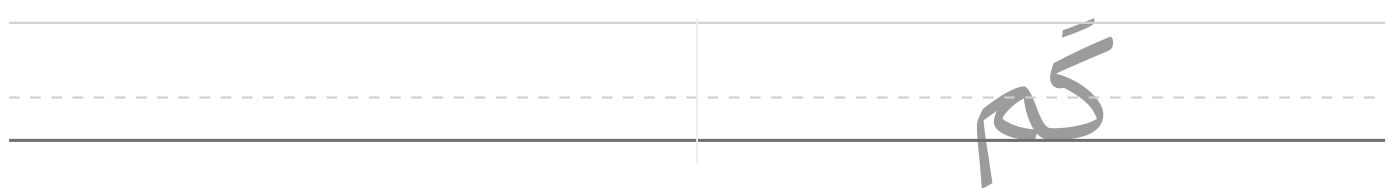
Middle of a word (the pen comes in along the line from the letter before)



End of a word (the pen comes in along the line from the letter before)



In a word: kam (few, less)



Trace and write: nūn

نون

Name _____ Date _____

nūn نون

Sound: 'n' in net

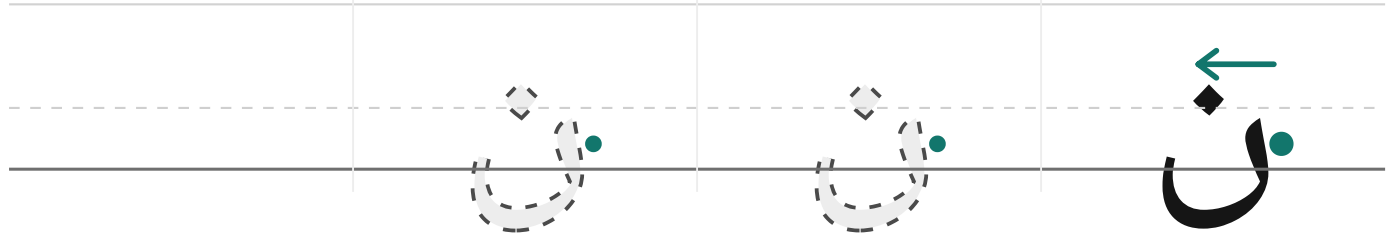
step 1: the body

step 2: 1 dot

How the pen moves: deep round bowl; dot last.

● Put your pencil on the green dot and follow the arrow. Say the sound as you write.

Alone



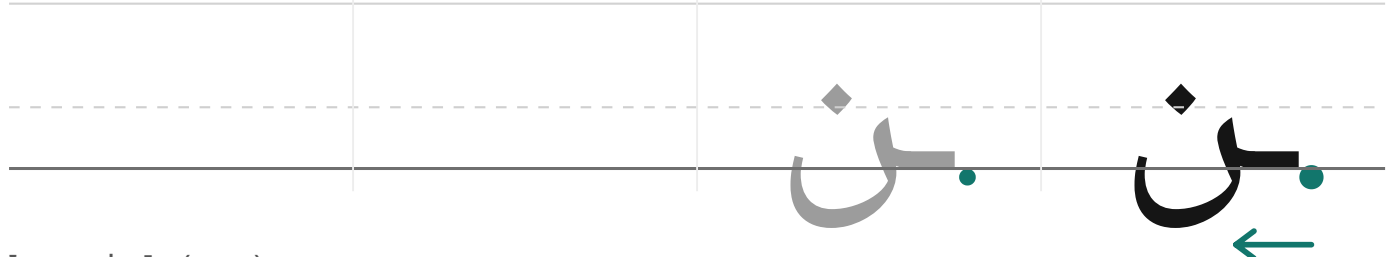
Start of a word (joins to the next letter)



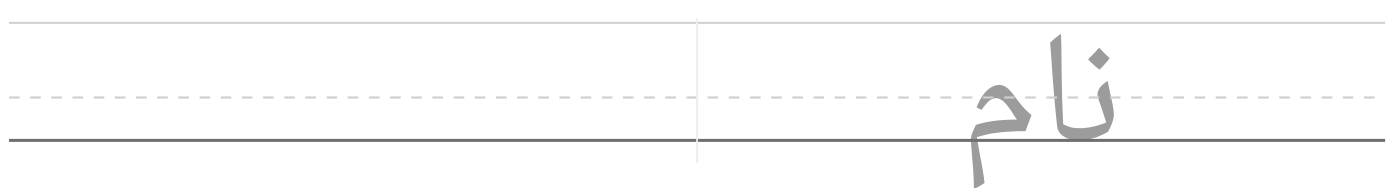
Middle of a word (the pen comes in along the line from the letter before)



End of a word (the pen comes in along the line from the letter before)



In a word: nām (name)



Look-alike letters

ملتے جلتے حرف

Name _____ Date _____

1 Circle every letter that is the same as the big one on the right.

ا	ن	ا	ل	ا	م	ک	ا
ک	ب	ب	ل	ب	ن	ا	ب
ک	ک	ل	ا	ک	ن	م	ک
ل	ک	ا	ب	ل	ن	م	ل
م	م	ل	ا	ک	ن	ب	م
ب	ن	ل	ن	ک	ا	ن	ن

2 Count the dots on each letter. Write the letter again in the box with that many dots.

ل	ب	ک	م	ن	ا
---	---	---	---	---	---

No dots	1 dot

Join the letters into a word

حرف جوڑیں

Name _____ Date _____

1 The letters are standing alone. Join them into a word. Read it out loud.

Joined letters change shape. Write the word from right to left. The first two words on each page have a grey guide to trace.

1

بِ ا ل كُ ل

Say: bilkul (absolutely)

بِ ا ل كُ ل

2

م ا لِ ك

Say: mālik (owner)

م ا لِ ك

3

لَ ا ب مْ

Say: lambā (long, tall)

4

ا مْ ك ا ن

Say: imkān (possibility)

Join the letters into a word

حرف جوڑیں

Name _____ Date _____

1 The letters are standing alone. Join them into a word. Read it out loud.

Joined letters change shape. Write the word from right to left. The first two words on each page have a grey guide to trace.

5

گ + ل + ا + م

Say: kalām (speech, words)

گلام

6

گ + م + ا + ل

Say: kamāl (perfection, skill)

گمال

7

ن + ا + ک + ا + م

Say: nākām (unsuccessful)

8

ن + ا + م + م + ک + ن

Say: nāmumkin (impossible)

Read and match

Name _____ Date _____

1 Read each Urdu word. Draw a line to its meaning.

a unsuccessful

b impossible

c owner

d hair

e to meet

f speech, words

g long, tall

h absolutely

i perfection, skill

j possibility

بِالْكُلِّ

مَالِك

لَمْبَا

إِمْكَان

گَلام

گَمَال

ناکام

نَامُمْكِن

مِلْنَا

بَال

Read and match

Name _____ Date _____

1 Read each Urdu word. Draw a line to its meaning.

a dear little boy

b blanket

c to take out

d bow

e to make

f perfect

g house

h kebab

i now

j nightingale

بَنانا

11

گَبَاب

12

مُنا

13

آب

14

بُلبُل

15

کَامِل

16

مَکَان

17

نِکالنا

18

گَمَان

19

گَمْبَل

20

Read the words

پڑھنے کی مشق

Name _____ Date _____

1 Read each word. Colour a circle each time you read it smoothly (three tries).

إِمْكَان

○ ○ ○

لَمْبَا

○ ○ ○

مَالِك

○ ○ ○

بِالْكُلِّ

○ ○ ○

نَامُمْكِن

○ ○ ○

نَاكَام

○ ○ ○

كَامَال

○ ○ ○

كَامَلَام

○ ○ ○

كَامَان

○ ○ ○

نِكَالْنَا

○ ○ ○

مَكَان

○ ○ ○

كَامِل

○ ○ ○

كَامَانَا

○ ○ ○

مِلَانَا

○ ○ ○

كَامْبَل

○ ○ ○

مِلْنَا

○ ○ ○

مِلَا

○ ○ ○

مُلْك

○ ○ ○

نَام

○ ○ ○

كَام

○ ○ ○

Grown-up corner. Say a word, let the child repeat it, then point. Sounds and meanings, from the right: bilkul (absolutely) · mālik (owner) · lambā (long, tall) · imkān (possibility) · kalām (speech, words) · kamāl (perfection, skill) · nākām (unsuccessful) · nāmumkin (impossible) · kāmīl (perfect) · makān (house) · nikālānā (to take out) · kamān (bow) · milnā (to meet) · kambal (blanket) · milānā (to mix, join) · kamānā (to earn) · kām (work) · nām (name) · mulk (country) · milā (met, got)

Read the words

پڑھنے کی مشق

Name _____ Date _____

1 Read each word. Colour a circle each time you read it smoothly (three tries).

مُمْكِن

○ ○ ○

مُكَمَّل

○ ○ ○

بِنَا

○ ○ ○

بَال

○ ○ ○

كَالَا

○ ○ ○

نَاك

○ ○ ○

بَنَانَا

○ ○ ○

مَال

○ ○ ○

مَانُنَا

○ ○ ○

نَمَك

○ ○ ○

كَان

○ ○ ○

مَان

○ ○ ○

كَبَاب

○ ○ ○

إِمْلَا

○ ○ ○

مَالَا

○ ○ ○

لَانَا

○ ○ ○

أَب

○ ○ ○

كَم

○ ○ ○

مَنَانَا

○ ○ ○

مُنَّا

○ ○ ○

Grown-up corner. Say a word, let the child repeat it, then point. Sounds and meanings, from the right: bāl (hair) · binā (without) · mukammal (complete) · mumkin (possible) · māl (goods, wealth) · banānā (to make) · nāk (nose) · kālā (black) · māl (pride, honour) · kār (ear) · namak (salt) · mānnā (to accept, obey) · lānā (to bring) · mālā (garland) · imlā (spelling) · kabāb (kebab) · munnā (dear little boy) · manānā (to persuade, celebrate) · kam (few, less) · ab (now)

Read the sentences

جملے پڑھیں

Name _____ Date _____

2 Read each line twice. Slide your finger under the words, right to left. Then trace it.

○ ○

بابا کا نام گمال

بابا کا نام گمال

○ ○

نانا کا مکان

نانا کا مکان

○ ○

کالا گمبل لانا

کالا گمبل لانا

Read the story

کہانی پڑھیں

Name _____ Date _____

3 Read the story. Then ask: who? where? what happened?

گَمال کا بابا۔ گَمال کا نانا۔ نانا کا مَکان لَمبّا۔ نانا کا گَمبَل کالا۔ گَمال کا
کام: نَمک لانا۔

Time it: ____ seconds. Words in the story: 19. Words per minute = $19 \times 60 \div \text{seconds}$.

For the grown-up: sounds and meanings

Read the lines aloud first, then let the child read them. Ask the three questions after the story.

1. bābā kā nām kamāl - dad's name is Kamal

2. nānā kā makān - grandfather's house

3. kālā kambal lānā - bring the black blanket

Story. kamāl kā bābā. kamāl kā nānā. nānā kā makān lambā. nānā kā kambal kālā. kamāl kā kām: namak lānā.

Meaning. Kamal's dad. Kamal's grandfather. Grandfather's house is long. Grandfather's blanket is black.
Kamal's job: bringing salt.

Listen and write

Name _____ Date _____

- 1** The grown-up says a word twice. Write it on the line, right to left. (The words are on the last page, for the grown-up.)

_____	1

_____	2

_____	3

_____	4

_____	5

_____	6

_____	7

_____	8

_____	9

_____	10

Listen and write: sentences

Name _____ Date _____

- 1** The grown-up reads a sentence slowly, a few words at a time. Write it on the lines. (The words and sentences are on the last pages, for the grown-up.)

1

2

3

4

Unit 1 check

Name _____ Date _____

A grown-up reads each prompt. No help with the letters. 10 questions, about 10 minutes.

1 Say: "be" ('b' in bat)



2 Say: "kāf" ('k' in kite)



3 Say: "lām" ('l' in log)



4 How many dots does this letter have?



5 Say: "kal" (tomorrow, yesterday)



6 Say: "milānā" (to mix, join)



7 Say: "māl" (goods, wealth)



8 Join the letters and write the word. Say: "nāk".



9 Join the letters and write the word. Say: "lambā".



10 Read this word out loud. Tick if it was right.

مِلَا

☐ right ☐ needs help

Score: _____ / 10

8 or more: ready for the next unit

Answer key: unit 1

For the grown-up. Keep this page; the child does not need it.

+ Look-alike letters, part 1: circle these (counting from the right)

Letter	Circles
ا	3, 5, 7
ب	3, 5, 6
ك	3, 6, 7
ل	3, 7
م	6, 7
ن	1, 4, 6

+ Look-alike letters, part 2: the dot boxes

Box	Letters
no dots	ا م ك ل
1 dot	ن ب

+ Read and match: which meaning goes with each word

1 → h	2 → c	3 → g	4 → j	5 → f	6 → i	7 → a	8 → b	9 → e	10 → d
11 → e	12 → h	13 → a	14 → i	15 → j	16 → f	17 → g	18 → c	19 → d	
20 → b									

Answer key: unit 1

For the grown-up. Keep this page; the child does not need it.

+ Join the letters: the words

#	Word	Say / meaning
1	بِالْكُلِّ	bilkul (absolutely)
2	مَالِك	mālik (owner)
3	لَمْبَا	lambā (long, tall)
4	إِمْكَان	imkān (possibility)
5	كَلَام	kalām (speech, words)
6	كَمَال	kamāl (perfection, skill)
7	نَاكَام	nākām (unsuccessful)
8	نَاْمُمْكِن	nāmumkin (impossible)

For the grown-up: what to say

Keep this page. Say each word twice, then check the child's page against the last column.

#	Say	Meaning	Check against
1	kāmil	perfect	کامِل
2	makān	house	مَکَان
3	nikālñā	to take out	نِکَالْنَا
4	kamān	bow	گَمَان
5	milñā	to meet	مِلْنَا
6	kambal	blanket	گَمْبَل
7	milāñā	to mix, join	مِلَانَا
8	kamāñā	to earn	گَمَانَا
9	kām	work	کَام
10	nām	name	نَام
S1	bābā kā nām kamāl (dad's name is Kamal)		بابا کا نام گمال
S2	nāñā kā makān (grandfather's house)		نانا کا مَکَان
S3	kālā kambal lāñā (bring the black blanket)		کالا گَمْبَل لانا
S4	namak kam (a little salt)		نَمَک گم

Marking: one tick for each word spelt correctly. A missing or wrong dot makes a different letter, so it counts as wrong. Small vowel marks are a bonus until unit 11.

Unit 1 check: answer key

Correct answers are circled. If the score is under 8: redo the look-alike sheet and the trace sheet for the letters that were missed, wait a day, try again.

- 1** If wrong, redo: trace + look-alike sheets for this letter
Say: "be" ('b' in bat)



- 2** If wrong, redo: trace + look-alike sheets for this letter
Say: "kāf" ('k' in kite)



- 3** If wrong, redo: trace + look-alike sheets for this letter
Say: "lām" ('l' in log)



- 4** If wrong, redo: look-alike sheet, part 2
How many dots does this letter have?



- 5** If wrong, redo: read-and-match + reading practice
Say: "kal" (tomorrow, yesterday)



- 6** If wrong, redo: read-and-match + reading practice
Say: "milānā" (to mix, join)



- 7** If wrong, redo: read-and-match + reading practice
Say: "māl" (goods, wealth)



- 8** If wrong, redo: join-the-letters sheet
Join the letters and write the word. Say: "nāk".



ناک

- 9** If wrong, redo: join-the-letters sheet
Join the letters and write the word. Say: "lambā".



لَمْبَا

- 10** If wrong, redo: reading practice words
Read this word out loud. Tick if it was right.

مِلَا

Answer: milā (met, got)